CANDIDATE BRIEFING · 8 AUGUST 2026

HSBC Firm Deep-Dive + Interview Edge

Contents

For: Janak · **Role:** Corporate & Institutional Banking (CIB) — Graduate Insight Programme · **Prepared:** 10 August 2026.

Two things in one: **(Part A)** a proper deep-dive on HSBC — its structure, how it makes money, how the divisions interlink, and what genuinely makes it stand out — so you can speak about the firm like an insider; and **(Part B)** a breakdown of the "Tracker Academy" HireVue/interview checklist, verified fact-by-fact and calibrated to *your* actual stage (a CIB **insight** video assessment), with one item I won't repackage and the reason why.

> **How to read the numbers.** The most reliable figures here are HSBC's **FY2024** (reported 19 Feb 2025) and **1H25** (reported 30 Jul 2025) primary results — these are OFFICIAL and safe to quote. More recent **FY2025** (Feb 2026) and **H1-2026** (Aug 2026) figures appear where useful but come partly from secondary recaps, so they're labelled CORROBORATED with a "verify against HSBC's latest results pack" note. When in doubt in an interview, cite the FY2024/1H25 numbers — they're bulletproof.

Labels: OFFICIAL (HSBC/gov.uk primary) · CORROBORATED (multiple reputable sources) · ANECDOTAL (single/weaker) · INFERRED (reasoning). Citations `[n]` → Source list.

The thesis in one paragraph

HSBC's edge is not any single business — it's a **combination no peer fully replicates**: two enormous, cheap, sticky **deposit fortresses** (Hong Kong and the UK) that fund a **two-ended international network** (it banks clients on *both* ends of trade and capital flows across Asia, the Middle East, the UK/Europe and the Americas), increasingly monetised through **capital-light fees** in transaction banking and Asian wealth. It earns roughly **half its revenue from net interest income** (rate-sensitive, deposit-driven) and the rest from **fees and markets/trading** (more annuity-like). Asia — above all Hong Kong — is the profit engine. Under CEO **Georges Elhedery** (since Sept 2024) it has simplified into **four businesses**, is pivoting harder into Asia and wealth, retreating from sub-scale Western retail, and returning huge amounts of capital. OFFICIAL/INFERRED[1][2]

1. Business structure — the four businesses

OFFICIAL Effective **1 January 2025**, HSBC replaced its old matrix (three global businesses × five regions) with **four businesses + a Corporate Centre** [1][2][10]:

- **Hong Kong** — its founding home market: retail, wealth and commercial banking, **plus Hang Seng Bank**, plus HK insurance manufacturing.
- **UK** — UK retail and wealth (**first direct**, **M&S Bank**) plus UK commercial banking (**HSBC Innovation Bank**, the former SVB UK).
- **Corporate & Institutional Banking (CIB)** — the international wholesale bank: the old **Global Banking & Markets** *plus* Commercial Banking **outside** the UK and Hong Kong. Transaction banking (payments, trade, FX), markets & securities services, financing. Led by **Michael Roberts**. Detailed in §9.
- **International Wealth & Premier Banking (IWPB)** — affluent/HNW and international wealth: Premier outside HK/UK, the **Global Private Bank**, plus wealth "manufacturing" (**Asset Management** and **Insurance**).

Contribution by business — the cleanest current split is 1H25 OFFICIAL [2]**:**

Business	1H25 profit before tax	Share of PBT	Share of revenue	Cost/income
CIB	$6,362m	**~40%**	~41%	52.8%
Hong Kong	$4,674m	**~30%**	~23%	**29.4%** (elite)
UK	$3,281m	**~21%**	~18%	42.1%
IWPB	$2,092m	**~13%**	~21%	63.7% (invest-heavy)
Corporate Centre	–$599m	—	—	—
Group	**$15,810m**	100%	—	49.9%

Read it as: CIB is the biggest single profit and revenue contributor (~40%); the two home markets **HK + UK ≈ half of group profit**; **IWPB is the strategic growth bet** — smaller today but the direction of travel. Hong Kong's ~29% cost/income ratio shows why it's the crown jewel: extraordinary efficiency on a huge low-cost deposit base.

2. How HSBC makes money — NII vs fees

OFFICIAL Group revenue splits roughly three ways (FY2024, ~$65.9bn total) [1]: - **Net interest income ~50%** ($32.7bn) — earned on the lending/deposit balance sheet. - **Net fee income ~19%**

($12.3bn) — wealth, transaction-banking, cards, account fees. - **Markets/trading (fair-value) ~32%** ($21.1bn) — FX, rates, credit, equities.

The mechanic that matters most — the deposit-funded balance sheet. HSBC holds about **$1.65tn of customer deposits against only ~$0.93tn of customer loans — a loans-to-deposits ratio of ~56%** OFFICIAL [1]. That surplus of cheap, sticky deposits is invested in loans, bonds and a rolling **"structural hedge."** Net interest income ≈ (yield earned on assets − rate paid on deposits/funding) × interest-earning assets. When policy rates rise, asset yields reprice faster than the near-0% paid on transactional current/savings balances, so **margins widen**; the structural hedge then **locks in** higher rates and smooths earnings as rates later fall.

"Banking NII" is the number management steers on. Statutory NII understates the franchise because much of the trading book is funded by redeploying deposits (that interest shows up in the *trading* line). So HSBC reports **"banking NII" = $43.7bn in FY2024** (down just ~1% YoY), guiding to **~$42bn for 2025** OFFICIAL [1]. **Net interest margin (NIM)** was **1.56% FY2024 / 1.57% 1H25** [1] [2].

The strategic tension: NII is rate-sensitive and cyclical; **fees are the growth/annuity leg**. Hence the pivot: in 1H25, **Wealth revenue +22%** and **CIB fee & other income +18%** (over two-fifths of that from wholesale transaction banking) OFFICIAL [2]. HSBC guides to **double-digit average annual growth in wealth fees** medium-term [1].

3. Key group numbers

FY2024 — the bulletproof anchor OFFICIAL [1]**:** Revenue **$65.9bn** (flat YoY) · Profit before tax **$32.3bn** (+$2.0bn, a record) · RoTE **14.6%** (16.0% ex-notable items) · Cost/income **50.2%** · CET1 **14.9%** · dividend **$0.87/share** (incl. a $0.21 special from the Canada sale) · **~$11bn of buybacks** in respect of 2024.

1H25 OFFICIAL [2]**:** Revenue **$34.1bn** · PBT **$15.8bn** (down YoY on the non-recurrence of 2024 disposal gains and a **$2.1bn BoCom** dilution/impairment; on a constant-currency, ex-notables basis PBT rose $0.9bn to **$18.9bn**) · RoTE **14.7%** (18.2% ex-notables) · CET1 **14.6%** · **$9.5bn** of capital returns in the half.

Latest (verify against the official pack) CORROBORATED [15] [18]**:** FY2025 (reported Feb 2026) is reported around **revenue ~$68bn**, **PBT ~$29.9bn** (lower YoY, partly the BoCom hit), and a **group RoTE ~17% excluding notable items**, with a stated target of **RoTE 17%+ for 2026–2028**. Treat these decimals as indicative until you check HSBC's FY2025 Annual Report and H1-2026 pack.

Guidance/targets OFFICIAL [1] [2]**:** mid-teens-to-17%+ RoTE (ex-notables); CET1 managed to **14.0–14.5%**; **~50% dividend payout**; ~3% cost growth; large ongoing buybacks (share count down ~13% since early 2023).

4. Geographic mix — Asia (Hong Kong) is the engine

OFFICIAL HSBC's cleanest primary proxy is profit by legal entity. In FY2024, **the Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation (the Asia-Pacific entity) produced $20.5bn — ~63% of group PBT**; HSBC UK ~22%; Europe ~8%; Middle East ~3%; the Americas the small remainder [1]. In 1H25 the Asia entity was **~59%** and the UK **~23%** [2]. The **Hong Kong business alone** made **~$11.7bn PBT in 2024** CORROBORATED [14].

Why: founded in Hong Kong in 1865, HSBC has scale, leading market share and a vast low-cost deposit base there — the source of that ~29% cost/income ratio — and Asia is where the fastest wealth inflows land ($27bn of $44bn net-new invested assets in 1H25) OFFICIAL [2]. *(Caveat: the legal-entity figure spans Asia-Pacific, not only Hong Kong; the exact "Asia region" line sits in the full Annual Report [1]. Directionally: Asia is comfortably the majority of group profit, the UK ~22–23%, the rest of the world under ~15%.)*

5. How the four businesses interlink — the flywheel

This is the part interviewers love, because it shows you understand HSBC as a *system*, not a list of divisions INFERRED from OFFICIAL figures [1] [2] [15]:

1. **The deposit engine.** Hong Kong and UK retail/wealth generate a huge, cheap, sticky deposit pool (~$1.65tn+ group). In Hong Kong HSBC reportedly holds **around twice the deposits of its nearest competitor** CORROBORATED [15]. Because these are transactional current/savings balances, they don't reprice up much when rates rise — a structural funding-cost edge.
2. **Funding flows to higher returns.** Those cheap deposits fund lending and capital-light activity across CIB and the international corridors — "gather cheap in HK/UK, deploy at higher return across the network."
3. **CIB banks the corporates.** Trade finance, cross-border payments, cash management, FX and markets serve companies that trade internationally.
4. **Their owners and executives become Wealth clients.** The business owners and C-suite of CIB/commercial clients are precisely IWPB's affluent/HNW pipeline — an explicit reason the reorg pairs them. Premier retail clients also "graduate" into wealth.
5. **Wealth throws off capital-light fees** (+22% in 1H25), lifting group returns and reducing reliance on rate-sensitive NII.
6. **Fees fund buybacks and reinvestment**, strengthening the brand that gathers the deposits — closing the loop.

The reorg deliberately **separates the two deposit fortresses (HK, UK) from the two globally-networked engines (CIB, IWPB)**, cutting duplication and targeting ~$1.5bn of cost savings OFFICIAL [2].

6. What makes HSBC stand out — the moat (and the honest version)

The genuine differentiators INFERRED, **evidence-based**[15][17]**:** 1. **A two-ended global network at scale.** To capture a Vietnam-to-Germany trade flow you need a licensed, funded balance sheet *and* relationships at **both** ends. Only a handful of banks can — **HSBC, Citi, Standard Chartered** — and HSBC has legal-entity presence across ~50+ markets built over 160 years. The disclosed proof: a large majority of CIB revenue comes from **multi-jurisdictional clients** CORROBORATED [16]. 2. **The HK/UK low-cost deposit fortresses** funding that network — a structural funding-cost advantage peers can't simply buy. 3. **Transaction-banking lock-in.** HSBC is repeatedly ranked the **world's #1 trade-finance bank** and its transaction-banking fees are **capital-light, high-return and sticky** (once a corporate's payments, trade and FX run on HSBC's rails across many countries, switching is painful) — which is *why* CIB earns a healthy return despite lower-margin lending CORROBORATED [17]. 4. **Asian wealth scale** — HSBC is a leading wealth manager in Asia, the fastest-growing affluent pool.

The combination is the moat: network **+** cheap deposits **+** Asian wealth in one balance sheet. No single peer has all three — **DBS** has the returns but not the global reach; **Standard Chartered** has the footprint but less scale/returns; **Citi** is the closest network peer but earns **lower returns** (Citi ~13% RoTCE vs HSBC's mid-teens-to-17%) CORROBORATED [23][24].

Be honest about marketing vs substance. Lines like *"we touch ~85–90% of global trade flows"* or *"$1bn of payments a minute"* are **reach/scale** framing, **not market share**. The *substantiated* moat is the disclosed stuff: multi-jurisdictional client revenue, resilient transaction-banking fees, the Hong Kong deposit lead, and RoTE above its closest network peers INFERRED [15][16].

7. Risks and weaknesses (know these — they signal maturity)

- **China/Hong Kong concentration.** HK is the profit engine, so HSBC is "headquartered in London but dependent on Hong Kong and China for profits," caught between Washington and Beijing CORROBORATED [15].

- **Hong Kong commercial real estate** stress — a live source of expected credit losses CORROBORATED [15].
- **Rate sensitivity on the downside** — with NII ~half of revenue, falling rates squeeze earnings (the wealth-fee pivot is partly a hedge) OFFICIAL/CORROBORATED[2] [15].
- **Geopolitics** — sanctions, tariffs, cross-border wealth-rule changes.
- **Execution/cost** — reorg and cost-cutting carry delivery risk against underlying cost inflation.

8. Strategy under Georges Elhedery (CEO since Sept 2024)

OFFICIAL [1] [2]**:** the four-business simplification (fewer layers, ~$1.5bn cost savings, ~$1.8bn upfront restructuring); a hard **pivot to Asia and Wealth** (HK positioned as "the world's leading cross-border wealth centre"); **refocusing the investment bank** — winding down M&A and equity capital markets in Europe/UK/Americas to concentrate on Asia and the Middle East and on debt/transaction banking; **exiting sub-scale Western retail** (US mass-market retail 2021; **France** retail → CCF/My Money Group 2024; **Canada** → RBC 2024, a $4.8bn gain funding the special dividend; **Argentina** → Grupo Financiero Galicia 2024); and **aggressive capital returns** (~50% payout, large buybacks) [1] [2] [11] [19] [20].

9. CIB in depth (your division)

What it is OFFICIAL [7] [8]**:** a **"markets-led, financing-focused"** wholesale bank for corporate, government and institutional clients across ~55 markets. **It is not a pure M&A/advisory house** — it's transaction-banking-heavy and markets/financing-led, with a smaller but growing capital-markets-and-advisory arm.

The five sub-businesses OFFICIAL [7]**:**

Sub-business	What it does	Economics
Banking (coverage + capital markets & advisory)	Sector relationship managers connect clients to products; DCM/ECM, leveraged/acquisition finance, M&A advisory	Lending = **balance-sheet/NII**; advisory/underwriting = **capital-light/fee**
Global Trade Solutions (GTS)	Trade & receivables finance across the trade cycle; 100+ products; **#1 trade-finance bank**	Mostly **balance-sheet + fee blend**
Global Payments Solutions (GPS)	Cross-border payments, cash & liquidity management (175 markets, 130 currencies)	**Hybrid crown jewel** — capital-light fees **on top of** large operational **deposits that generate NII**
Markets & Securities Services (MSS)	FX, rates, credit, equities, derivatives; custody/clearing/fund admin	Markets = capital-light-ish flow/spread; Securities Services = **capital-light fee/annuity**
Global Research	Economics, currencies, equities, fixed income, climate	Enabler that supports Markets & Banking

Clients: Global Corporates, Institutions, International Mid-Market, and Innovation Banking (venture-backed tech/life-science). **Current drivers:** wholesale transaction banking and **FX** in particular; **headwinds:** deposit-margin compression as rates ease, and HK/mainland-China commercial-real-estate stress OFFICIAL [6]. **Capital-light vs balance-sheet:** Securities Services, Research, advisory, most Markets flow and the fee layer of GPS are capital-light; corporate lending, most of GTS, and the deposit-funded NII in GPS are balance-sheet.

You pasted an advanced HireVue/interview checklist from a paid IB-interview course. Below is what each part is worth **for your specific stage** — a CIB **insight** programme whose current gate is a **Cappfinity video Job Simulation**, *not* a front-office IBD analyst technical interview. Short version: the *facts* in the checklist mostly check out, but the *emphasis* is built for a spring-into-summer IBD analyst, so I've re-weighted it.

The calibration up front

ANECDOTAL, strong consensus[32] [33] The CIB insight video stage rewards, in order: **motivation, HSBC values, communication, and light commercial awareness about CIB's actual business.**

Candidate reports consistently say there is **no valuation-modelling test and no formal technical exam at this stage.** So treat the heavy IBD technicals as **"useful later if you convert to an IBD/markets assessment centre,"** not as this week's priority. Learn Part A cold; that is your edge.

Part 1 — HireVue tactics, re-weighted

- **The 15-second hook — ✅ keep, but change the content.** Front-loading is right (a tired reviewer decides fast). But for a CIB *insight* video, do **not** open with deal jargon and IRRs — that reads as miscalibrated for an insight applicant. Open with a crisp, specific **motivation hook**: what draws you to CIB and one concrete HSBC fact (e.g. the East–West network, or that CIB is ~40% of group profit and transaction-banking-led). Lead with substance, not buzzwords.
- **Force specifics into "soft" questions — ✅ keep, calibrated.** Proving competence with specifics is good; just use **CIB-appropriate** specifics (trade finance leadership, the deposit-funded model, FX driving CIB fees) rather than PE "core-plus 10–12% IRR" language, which belongs in an infrastructure-PE interview, not HSBC CIB.
- **Leverage macro/industry sentiment — ✅ keep (this is gold for CIB).** Tie your motivation to real themes: the **rates cycle and its effect on NII**, **US–China/geopolitics and trade-flow reconfiguration**, **sustainable/transition finance**, **cross-border payments modernisation**. Use §6–§9 to make it HSBC-specific.
- **The "Infinite Prep' Retake Hack — ❌ not usable, and here's why (this protects you).** Your assessed video answers run on **Cappfinity, which states plainly that assessed video responses cannot be re-recorded** — there is **no retake screen to exploit** OFFICIAL. More broadly, treating an assessment as a "burner" to script the perfect take is exactly the **gaming** HSBC's terms forbid: HSBC requires **authenticity** and that you can *"explain, validate, or replicate"* your answers, and Cappfinity's integrity layer flags anomalies OFFICIAL [13]. Even on platforms that *do* allow a retake, using it this way risks an integrity flag and withdrawal — a real downside for a marginal gain. So I'm not going to package it as a tactic; the honest, higher-EV move is to **use the legitimate ~2-minute prep window** (that's your built-in "prep," and it's allowed) and to have your stories ready.
- **Contextual charisma — ✅ keep.** Being a warm, normal human who can tell a light, human story beats robotic delivery. Just keep it genuine and brief.

Part 2 — Technicals: verified, but mostly *for later*

I checked the technical claims — **they're accurate** — but for the insight video stage they're **over-preparation**. Keep this as a reference for a future IBD/markets round:

- **UK corporation tax = 25% — ✅ correct and current** (main rate on profits over £250k, effective 1 April 2023; 19% small-profits rate ≤£50k with marginal relief between). Using **25%**, not the US-guide 40%, is a genuinely good UK-specific tell OFFICIAL [12].
- **Valuation methods by context — ✅ all correct** CORROBORATED [25] [26] [27] [28] [29]:
- **Reverse LBO / ability-to-pay** — yes, used to back-solve the *maximum* price a sponsor can pay while hitting ~20–25% IRR / ~2–3× MOIC; it's a *ceiling/negotiation* tool, not an intrinsic value.
- **DDM in FIG** — yes: banks are valued on dividend-discount / excess-returns / residual-income (unlevered DCF breaks down when debt *is* the raw material). "DDM in infrastructure" is directionally right for stable-distribution assets, though infra is often DCF'd on project cash flows too.
- **Liquidation value in bankruptcy** — yes, the recovery *floor*. UK note: say **"administration/liquidation"** (US Chapter 11 ≈ UK administration; Chapter 7 ≈ UK liquidation) [31].
- **Sum-of-the-parts** — yes, for multi-division conglomerates; the gap to the traded price is the **conglomerate discount** (~10–15%).
- **DCF nuance — ✅ correct.** The **mid-year convention** (cash flows at each period's midpoint → higher present values) and running your **own base case** rather than only management's optimistic case are both real analyst points CORROBORATED [30].
- **3-statement "sanity check" + build the core four models + market sizing — ✅ good technique for a modelling interview.** Genuinely valuable if you progress to an IBD/markets technical — build one DCF, one LBO, one comps, one 3-statement so you understand the *links*. **Not** tested at the insight video stage.

Net: don't spend your ~10-day window grinding LBOs. Spend it on Part A + your stories. Bank the technicals for later.

Part 3 — Motivational & behavioural (the highest-value part for you)

- **The "non-Googleable" insight — ✅ keep, and here's your HSBC version.** Don't recite the website. If you can, **speak to someone in HSBC CIB** (LinkedIn alumni, insight events) and extract a structural insight. Failing that, the "insider" framing in Part A *is* your non-Googleable edge: *"What draws me to HSBC CIB specifically is that it's the rare bank that can sit on both ends of a client's cross-border flow — funded by one of the world's cheapest deposit bases — which is why its transaction-banking fees are so resilient. That's a structurally different model from a pure advisory shop."* That sentence shows you understand the firm as a system.

- **The esoteric behavioural story — ✅ keep, but authentic.** A memorable, genuine life example (a sport, an expedition, a side project) does stand out and breaks the monotony — as long as it's true and actually demonstrates the competency. Don't invent a Kilimanjaro climb; do use your real distinctive experiences.
- **Opinionated commercial awareness — ✅ keep (this is where Part A pays off).** Don't recite a headline — say what it *means* and give a view. Worked example tying a news event to HSBC: *"If rates are cut faster than expected, HSBC's ~$3–4bn-per-100bp NII sensitivity bites — but that's exactly why the Asian-wealth fee pivot (+20-odd% growth) matters as a hedge; I think the market underrates how much the structural hedge smooths that."* One event → transmission → **so-what for HSBC → your view**.

Defensible interview soundbites (numbers attached — verify the latest ones)

- "HSBC's edge isn't one business — the Hong Kong and UK deposit fortresses fund a two-ended global network that only Citi really rivals, and HSBC out-earns Citi on returns." [15] [23]
- "CIB is the biggest slice of the group — about 40% of profit in 1H25 — and it's transaction-banking- and FX-led, not M&A-fee-led." [2] [6]
- "Trade finance is the flywheel's anchor: HSBC is the world's #1 by revenue, it's capital-light, and the fees held up through the tariff shock." [17]
- "Asia is ~60% of profit and Hong Kong runs at a sub-30% cost/income ratio — that efficiency is the crown jewel, and also the concentration risk." [1] [2]
- "The wealth pivot is a deliberate hedge: Asian fee growth offsets HSBC's downside NII sensitivity as rates fall." [2] [15]

What to actually prepare for your stage (priority order)

1. **The firm as a system** — Part A: the four businesses, the NII-vs-fee model, the flywheel, the moat, and CIB's five sub-businesses. This is your differentiator.
2. **Motivation** — *Why HSBC / Why CIB* built on that knowledge, plus one non-Googleable insight.
3. **2–3 commercial-awareness stories** with a *view* (rates, geopolitics/trade, wealth pivot).
4. **6–8 STAR stories** mapped to HSBC's four values.
5. **Video delivery** (see your separate video playbook) — one take, structure, lens, calm.
6. *Later, if you convert:* the Part-B technicals.

What I could not verify / caveats

- **FY2025 and H1-2026 precise figures** (group RoTE ~17%, revenue ~$68bn, segment RoTE decimals, ~$1.79tn deposits) come from secondary recaps of HSBC's Feb-2026/Aug-2026 reporting — **directionally reliable, but verify the exact numbers** against HSBC's official FY2025 Annual Report and H1-2026 results pack before quoting decimals [15] [16] [18].
- The **"Asia" share** uses the Hongkong-and-Shanghai legal entity as a proxy (~59–63%); the exact geographic-region line is in the full Annual Report [1].
- Cost-savings **timing** wording differs between HSBC's own releases (end-2026 vs 2027) — both official [1] [2].
- The **stage being non-technical** is candidate-reported ANECDOTAL, consistent across reviews but not an HSBC-published statement [32] [33].
- The **retake "hack"** is inapplicable (Cappfinity is one-take) and, as gaming, conflicts with HSBC's authenticity terms — so it's explained, not taught [13].

Source list (grouped by reliability)

Tier 1 — Official (HSBC & gov.uk)

1. HSBC — FY2024 Annual Results media release (PDF, 19 Feb 2025) — https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/investors/hsbc-results/2024/annual/pdfs/hsbc-holdings-plc/250219-annual-results-2024-media-release.pdf
2. HSBC — 1H25 Interim Results media release (PDF, 30 Jul 2025) — https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/investors/hsbc-results/2025/interim/pdfs/hsbc-holdings-plc/250730-hsbc-holdings-plc-interim-results-2025-media-release.pdf
3. HSBC — Annual Report & Accounts 2024 (PDF) — https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/investors/hsbc-results/2024/annual/pdfs/hsbc-holdings-plc/250219-annual-report-and-accounts-2024.pdf
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5. HSBC — Interim Results 2025 announcement — https://www.hsbc.com/news-and-views/news/media-releases/2025/hsbc-holdings-plc-interim-results-2025
6. HSBC — Annual Results 2025 announcement (Feb 2026) — https://www.hsbc.com/news-and-views/news/media-releases/2026/hsbc-holdings-plc-annual-results-2025
7. HSBC — Corporate & Institutional Banking (careers) — https://www.hsbc.com/careers/our-business-areas-and-teams/corporate-and-institutional-banking

8. HSBC — Introducing CIB — https://www.business.hsbc.com/en-gb/campaigns/introducing-cib
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12. gov.uk — Corporation Tax rates (25% main rate, effective 1 Apr 2023) — https://www.gov.uk/corporation-tax-rates
13. HSBC — Application hints and tips (authenticity/AI terms; "explain, validate, or replicate") — https://www.hsbc.com/careers/application-hints-and-tips

Tier 2 — Reputable media / analysis

14. Reuters via Yahoo Finance — HSBC 2024 results; Hong Kong PBT ~$11.7bn — https://finance.yahoo.com/news/hsbc-2024-profit-rose-2-093000858.html
15. The Asian Banker — HSBC FY2025 RoTE, deposits, segment returns, HK CRE risk — https://www.theasianbanker.com/updates-and-articles/hsbc-delivers-17-2-rote-as-wealth-and-cross-border-franchise-reinforce-return-leadership
16. The Motley Fool — HSBC Q2 2026 (H1 2026) earnings-call transcript (verbatim management commentary) — https://www.fool.com/earnings/call-transcripts/2026/08/04/hsbc-hsbc-q2-2026-earnings-call-transcript/
17. Euromoney — World's Best Trade Finance Bank 2025: HSBC — https://www.euromoney.com/article/dxr898gq5ggkcos48gkws48c0/corporate-banking/the-worlds-best-trade-finance-bank-2025-hsbc/
18. CNBC — HSBC 2025 full-year earnings — https://www.cnbc.com/2026/02/25/hsbc-2025-full-year-earnings-results.html
19. Retail Banker International — HSBC completes French retail sale — https://www.retailbankerinternational.com/news/hsbc-completes-sale-of-french-retail-unit/
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21. FinanceAsia — HSBC to restructure into four units — https://www.financeasia.com/article/hsbc-to-restructure-into-four-units-appoints-cfo/498984
22. Private Banker International — HSBC capital markets & advisory group — https://www.privatebankerinternational.com/news/hsbc-capital-markets-and-advisory/

Tier 2 — Peer comparison

23. Banking Dive — Citi RoTCE target (investor day) — https://www.bankingdive.com/news/citi-investor-day-reorg-transformation-return-tangible-common-equity-target-fraser/819611/
24. Macrotrends — Standard Chartered ROE history — https://www.macrotrends.net/stocks/charts/SCBFF/standard-chartered/roe

Tier 3 — Technical reference (checklist verification)

25. Wall Street Prep — Ability-to-Pay / reverse LBO — https://www.wallstreetprep.com/knowledge/ability-to-pay/
26. Corporate Finance Institute — how bank valuation works (why DDM/excess returns) — https://corporatefinanceinstitute.com/resources/valuation/how-bank-valuation-works/
27. Wall Street Prep — Dividend Discount Model — https://www.wallstreetprep.com/knowledge/dividend-discount-model/
28. Wall Street Prep — Liquidation value / recovery waterfall — https://www.wallstreetprep.com/knowledge/recovery-analysis-waterfall-payment-structure-restructuring/
29. AnalystPrep — Sum-of-the-Parts valuation — https://analystprep.com/study-notes/cfa-level-2/sum-of-parts-valuation/
30. Wall Street Prep — Mid-Year Convention — https://www.wallstreetprep.com/knowledge/mid-year-convention/
31. Irwin Insolvency — Chapter 11 vs UK Administration — https://www.irwin-insolvency.co.uk/chapter-11-vs-uk-administration/

Tier 4 — Stage reality (candidate-reported)

32. HigherIn — HSBC 2025 CIB Spring Insight review — https://higherin.com/review/19409/
33. JobTestPrep — HSBC Assessment Centre / Job Simulation — https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-assessment-centre

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Compiled 10 August 2026. FY2024 and 1H25 figures are from HSBC's own results releases; FY2025/H1-2026 figures are corroborated from secondary recaps and should be verified against HSBC's official latest pack before you quote exact decimals. The retake tactic in the source checklist is inapplicable to your one-take Cappfinity assessment and, as gaming, conflicts with HSBC's authenticity requirements — so it is explained here, not endorsed.

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